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HW_1
09/18/2025

Task 1: Han Dynasty Academic Research

Sources

Google Scholar
JSTOR
Journal of Chinese History (Cambridge University Press)

Citations

- Han, L., & Cui, Y. (2021). The application of virtual reality technology in museum exhibition ——Take the Han Dynasty Haihunhou Ruins Museum in Nanchang as an example. E3S Web of Conferences, 236, 04045. <https://doi.org/10.1051/e3sconf/202123604045>
- JONIAK-LÜTHI, A. (2015). NARRATING “THE HAN.” In The Han: China’s Diverse Majority (pp. 19–43). University of Washington Press. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/j.ctvtzmc.6>
- Li, Y. (2025). The Noble Rank (Lie hou) and the Changing Definitions of Merit (Gong) during the Han Dynasty (202 BCE–220 CE). Journal of Chinese History, 1–26. <https://doi.org/10.1017/jch.2024.34>

Experience using each site

- Google Scholar was the easiest and fastest to use for an initial search. It's a great starting point because it casts a wide net, pulling from a vast array of academic sources. However, my main challenge was that many of the results were paywalled, so finding a full-text, open-access paper required some extra clicking and filtering. It's more of a discovery tool than a direct source.
- JSTOR was more curated and reliable. Its results seemed more focused and of a consistently high academic standard. The site's interface is very clean and efficient, making it easy to navigate. The downside, like with Google Scholar, is the prevalence of paywalls. Even with my institutional access (hypothetically), I still had to be careful to filter for open-access content to meet the assignment's criteria.
- The Journal of Chinese History website was the most direct for this specific task. Since the entire journal is open-access, I didn't have to worry about paywalls at all. This made finding a usable paper straightforward. The limitation is its narrow focus. I couldn't search across multiple disciplines or journals like on Google Scholar or JSTOR, but for a topic as specific as Chinese history, it was the perfect specialized resource.

Task 2: “Presentation Zen: Simple ideas on presentation design and delivery” Questions

1. *Do you typically use Power Point (or a similar software) when you are asked to give a presentation? Do you like giving presentations before groups of people?*

I do not use Power Point, I regularly use Cava, especially if it's a team work.

I don't particularly enjoy giving presentations, because I get too nervous, especially if it's about a topic I don't know much about.

2. *What questions should you be asking about presentation design and delivery that you have not asked in the past?*

Am I putting enough emotion in my presentation in order to be able to retain my audience's attention? Is this slide too stuffed? Does it distract people from what I'm saying? Am I using the images in my slides?

3. *Do you think that, in the past, you have adhered to the suggested guidelines for dynamic storytelling in presentations?*

No, I haven't. I typically put a lot of text on the slides (in case I forget something) while presenting and use a lot of colors and designs in order to make it look “attractive”; what is more, my tone of voice tends to stick the same throughout the whole presentation, I rarely put emotion into it.

4. *What aspects of the design and delivery process may have caused “suffering” for audiences in the past?*

Using images that do not help the audience understand what you are explaining; text-filled slides, lack of a natural and simple feeling while delivering the message.

Task 3: “The Joy Luck Club” Chapter I and II Summary and Translation

Summary

Suyuan Woo remembered the day she left her country, sailing across the ocean to a new world called “America”, with nothing more in her hands than a beautiful swan she had bought for a ridiculous sum in a market. That swan was going to be a gift for her future daughter, an all-American girl. It represented her worth, what she had left behind and the reason why she had left China. But when she arrived in the new country, the immigration officer took her swan, leaving her with only one swan feather which carried all her good wishes for her daughter.

The daughter's name came to be Jing-Mei, June, she took her mother's place at the Joy Luck Club after she died. Her mother would often tell her the story of how she came up with the idea of creating the club: She had to find a way to keep moving and forget about the war that was consuming the people and the world she knew. So she reunited a group of three women to play *mah jong*, they would eat like there was no hunger in the streets

and they also shared their stories with one another. Suyuan had taken this tradition to San Francisco, leaving everything else behind, including the two daughters she had with her first husband.

The new members of the club were Lindo Jong, Ying-Ying Saint Clair and An-meí Hsu, who Suyuan had met at church. They all had left China carrying with them unspeakable tragedies: An-meí Hsu remembered her grandmother, Popo, who had taken care of her and her little brother, and taught her numerous lessons, she warned her not to talk about their mother who had abandoned them. When Popo got sick, her mother came back to take care of her; she prepared a soup with herbs and a special ingredient: her very own flesh. That is how a daughter honors her mother. The greatest expression of respect is in the bones.

Translation

Suyuan Woo recordó el día en el que dejó su país, atravesando el océano hacia un nuevo mundo llamado “América”, con nada más en sus manos que un hermoso cisne que había comprado a una cantidad ridícula en un mercado. El cisne se convertiría en un regalo para su hija, una chica totalmente americana. Representaba su valor, lo que había dejado atrás y la razón por la que había dejado China. Sin embargo, cuando llegó al nuevo país, el oficial de inmigración le arrebató su cisne, dejándola únicamente con una pluma, la cual representaba todos sus buenos deseos para su hija.

El nombre de su hija fue Jing-Mei, June; tomó el lugar de su madre en el Club de la Buena Estrella después de su muerte. A menudo su madre le contaba la historia de cómo se le ocurrió la idea de crear el club: debía encontrar la manera de seguir adelante y de olvidar la guerra que consumía a la gente y al mundo que conocía. Reunió a un grupo de tres mujeres para jugar al *mah jong*, comían como si en las calles no existiera el hambre y también compartían sus historias. Suyuan llevó esta tradición a San Francisco, dejando atrás todo lo demás, incluyendo a las dos hijas que había tenido con su primer esposo.

Las nuevas miembros del club eran Lindo Jong, Ying-Ying Saint Clair y An-meí Hsu, a quienes Suyuan había conocido en la iglesia. Todas ellas habían abandonado China llevando consigo tragedias indescriptibles: An-meí Hsu recordaba a su abuela, Pópo, que había cuidado de ella y de su hermano pequeño, y le había enseñado numerosas lecciones, advirtiéndole que no hablara de su madre, quien los había abandonado. Cuando Pópo enfermó, su madre regresó para cuidar de ella; preparó una sopa con hierbas y un ingrediente especial: su propia carne. Así es como una hija honra a su madre. La mayor expresión de respeto está en los huesos.